Aside from the general convenience these helpers provide, many of them also handle internationalization and localization. In Chapter 15, *Task J: Internationalization*, we translated much of the application. Many of the helpers we used handled that for us, such as `number_to_currency`. It's always a good practice to use Rails helpers where they're appropriate, even if it seems just as easy to hard-code the output you want.

Formatting Helpers

One set of helper methods deals with dates, numbers, and text:

```
<%= distance_of_time_in_words(Time.now, Time.local(2016, 12, 25)) %>
```

4 months

```
<%= distance_of_time_in_words(Time.now, Time.now + 33, include_seconds: false) %>
```

1 minute

```
<%= distance_of_time_in_words(Time.now, Time.now + 33, include_seconds: true) %>
```

Half a minute

```
<%= time_ago_in_words(Time.local(2012, 12, 25)) %>
```

7 months

```
<%= number_to_currency(123.45) %>
```

$123.45

```
<%= number_to_currency(234.56, unit: "CAN$", precision: 0) %>
```

CAN$235

```
<%= number_to_human_size(123_456) %>
```

120.6 KB

```
<%= number_to_percentage(66.66666) %>
```

66.667%

```
<%= number_to_percentage(66.66666, precision: 1) %>
```

66.7%